

THE PEOPLE FIRST AGENDA

A Manifesto for Effective Representation, Sustainable Development and Inclusive Growth

COMRADE ARUNA ABUBAKARI

ADC CANDIDATE FOR EDO NORTH SENATORIAL DISTRICT

Service | Integrity | Development | Representation

FOREWORD

A New Promise of Responsible Leadership

The greatness of any society is measured by the quality of leadership it receives and the commitment of those entrusted with public responsibility.

Edo North is blessed with remarkable people. Our communities are filled with hardworking men and women, talented youths, visionary entrepreneurs, farmers, professionals, traditional institutions and citizens who continue to contribute meaningfully to the development of our state and nation.

However, despite our enormous potential, many of our communities still face challenges that require urgent attention. Our young people seek opportunities to build meaningful careers. Our farmers require stronger support systems. Our businesses need an environment where they can grow. Our communities need better infrastructure, improved healthcare services, stronger educational opportunities and effective representation.

The office of a Senator is not merely a political position. It is a responsibility to serve as a voice, an advocate, a bridge between the people and government, and a champion for policies that improve the lives of citizens.

I, **Comrade Aruna Abubakari**, present this manifesto as a covenant of service to the people of Edo North.

This document represents my commitment to a new era of representation — a representation built on listening, accountability, accessibility and measurable impact.

My aspiration is not simply to occupy a seat at the National Assembly. My aspiration is to use that position to advance the interests of Edo North, attract opportunities, support development initiatives and ensure that the voices of our people are heard.

Together, we can build an Edo North where:

- Our youths have opportunities to succeed.
- Our women are empowered economically.
- Our farmers receive the support they deserve.
- Our communities experience meaningful development.
- Our businesses thrive.
- Our people enjoy stronger representation.
- Our future generations inherit a better society.

This is the vision behind **The People First Agenda**.

ABOUT COMRADE ARUNA ABUBAKARI

Comrade Aruna Abubakari represents a new generation of leadership built on experience, service and commitment to community development.

His journey reflects years of dedication to professional excellence, grassroots engagement and public service.

Born on **12 September 1974**, from **Jagbe Ward, Etsako West Local Government Area of Edo State**, Comrade Aruna has developed a deep understanding of the challenges facing ordinary citizens and the importance of responsible leadership.

His educational background includes:

- National Diploma in Banking and Finance, Auchi Polytechnic.
- Advanced Diploma in Accounting, Obafemi Awolowo University.
- Qualification with the Association of National Accountants of Nigeria (ANAN).

Beyond academics, he has built experience across professional, labour and community development spaces.

His background includes:

- Community development advocacy.
- Labour leadership experience.
- Engagement with workers and communities.

- Experience within structures connected to NUPENG, NNPC and PPMC.
- Private sector leadership as Executive Director, Touch Engineering Properties & Construction.

These experiences have strengthened his understanding of governance, economic development, workers' welfare, community needs and the importance of effective representation.

Comrade Aruna believes that leadership must be measured by impact, not promises.

OUR VISION FOR EDO NORTH

To build a prosperous, inclusive and empowered Edo North where every citizen has access to opportunities, quality representation and the support needed to achieve their full potential.

OUR MISSION

To provide effective and accountable representation at the National Assembly by:

- Championing people-centred legislation.
- Attracting development opportunities.
- Supporting economic empowerment.
- Advocating for better infrastructure.
- Promoting youth and women development.
- Strengthening community engagement.
- Ensuring that Edo North has a strong voice at the national level.

MY LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY

Leadership is Service

Public office is not a personal reward. It is a responsibility entrusted by the people.

A true representative must:

- Listen before acting.
- Understand before making decisions.
- Serve before seeking recognition.
- Deliver results instead of making empty promises.

My approach to leadership will be guided by four principles:

1. Accessibility

The people must always have access to their representative.

I will maintain continuous engagement with communities across Edo North through:

- Town hall meetings.
- Community consultations.
- Stakeholder engagements.
- Youth and women forums.
- Regular feedback platforms.

2. Accountability

The people have the right to know how their representative is working for them.

I will promote transparency through:

- Periodic updates on activities.
- Reporting of legislative efforts.
- Community feedback sessions.
- Open communication channels.

3. Development-Oriented Representation

Representation must translate into visible improvements.

My focus will be on:

- Policies that create opportunities.
- Projects that improve lives.
- Partnerships that attract investment.
- Programs that empower citizens.

4. Inclusive Leadership

Every group matters.

My representation will include:

- Youths.

- Women.
- Farmers.
- Traders.
- Professionals.
- Persons with disabilities.
- Traditional institutions.
- Community leaders.

UNDERSTANDING THE CHALLENGES OF EDO NORTH

Before proposing solutions, effective leadership requires a proper understanding of the challenges facing the people.

Edo North Senatorial District is made up of diverse communities with rich cultural heritage, talented citizens and enormous economic potential. The district has produced great professionals, entrepreneurs, community leaders and contributors to national development.

However, many communities still experience challenges that require strategic attention and stronger advocacy.

These challenges include:

1. Youth Unemployment and Limited Opportunities

Our young population represents our greatest strength, but many young people face difficulties accessing quality employment, entrepreneurship opportunities and relevant skills required in today's economy.

The world is changing rapidly. Technology, digital innovation and new industries are creating opportunities globally, but many young people need the right skills, mentorship and support to participate effectively.

A government that invests in its youths invests in the future.

2. Infrastructure Deficit

Roads, electricity, water supply and other basic infrastructure remain important factors affecting economic growth and quality of life.

Communities cannot experience meaningful development without the infrastructure required to support businesses, education, healthcare and social activities.

3. Agricultural Challenges

Agriculture remains a major source of livelihood for many families across Edo North. However, farmers face challenges including:

- Limited access to financing.
- Lack of modern farming equipment.
- Poor storage facilities.
- Weak market connections.
- Rising production costs.

Supporting agriculture means supporting food security, employment and rural development.

4. Healthcare Accessibility

Many communities still require improved access to quality and affordable healthcare.

Healthcare is not only about hospitals; it is about ensuring that citizens can access preventive care, medical support and health education.

5. Economic Pressure on Families and Businesses

Small businesses, traders and entrepreneurs are the backbone of local economies. However, many struggle with:

- Limited access to capital.
- High operating costs.
- Lack of business support systems.
- Limited access to markets.

A stronger economic environment will create more opportunities for families and communities.

6. Need for Stronger National Representation

The people of Edo North deserve a representative who understands their realities and can effectively present their interests at the National Assembly.

Representation must go beyond speeches. It must involve:

- Strategic advocacy.

- Legislative action.
- Government partnerships.
- Development initiatives.
- Consistent engagement with citizens.

THE PEOPLE FIRST 15-POINT DEVELOPMENT AGENDA

My commitment to Edo North is built around fifteen strategic pillars designed to address the needs of our people and create sustainable development.

PILLAR ONE

Youth Empowerment, Innovation and Future Skills Development

The future belongs to those who are prepared for it.

Our youths are talented, creative and ambitious. What they need is an environment that provides opportunities to learn, create and succeed.

As Senator representing Edo North, I will champion programmes focused on preparing young people for the modern economy.

My Commitments:

Digital Skills and Technology Training

I will support initiatives that expose young people to:

- Artificial intelligence.
- Software development.
- Digital marketing.
- Cybersecurity.
- Data analysis.
- Creative technology.
- Online entrepreneurship.

The world is moving towards a digital economy, and our youths must not be left behind.

Entrepreneurship Support

I will advocate for programmes that provide:

- Business training.
- Mentorship.
- Access to funding opportunities.
- Business development support.
- Networking platforms.

Young entrepreneurs should have the support needed to transform ideas into successful businesses.

Skills Acquisition Programmes

I will promote vocational and technical training in areas such as:

- Fashion and design.
- Agriculture.
- Construction.
- Renewable energy.
- Automotive skills.
- Creative industries.
- Technology services.

Every young person should have an opportunity to acquire a valuable skill.

PILLAR TWO

Education Development and Human Capital Growth

Education remains the foundation of every successful society.

A society that neglects education limits its future.

My education agenda will focus on improving opportunities for students, supporting teachers and encouraging modern learning approaches.

My Commitments:

Educational Support Programmes

I will support initiatives that provide:

- Scholarships for deserving students.
- Educational assistance for vulnerable learners.
- Support materials for schools.
- Academic mentorship programmes.

Modern Learning Opportunities

The world has changed, and education must evolve.

I will advocate for:

- Digital learning programmes.
- Technology-enabled classrooms.
- Computer literacy initiatives.
- Skills-based education.

Support for Teachers

Teachers are critical to national development.

I will promote initiatives that encourage:

- Professional development.
- Better teaching resources.
- Recognition of outstanding educators.

PILLAR THREE

Agriculture Transformation and Food Security

Agriculture is not just a means of survival; it is a major economic opportunity.

Edo North has fertile land and hardworking farmers. The challenge is creating the right support system.

My agricultural agenda will focus on moving farmers from subsistence farming to profitable agriculture.

My Commitments:

Farmer Support Programmes

I will advocate for:

- Better access to agricultural loans.
- Farming equipment support.
- Improved seedlings and inputs.
- Agricultural extension services.

Youth Participation in Agriculture

Agriculture must become attractive to young people.

I will support programmes that encourage youths to participate in:

- Agribusiness.
- Food processing.
- Agricultural technology.
- Export-oriented farming.

Agricultural Value Chain Development

Farmers should not only produce; they should benefit from the value created.

I will promote:

- Processing opportunities.
- Better market access.
- Storage solutions.
- Partnerships with investors.

PILLAR FOUR

Infrastructure Development and Community Transformation

Infrastructure remains one of the strongest foundations for economic growth and improved quality of life.

No community can fully achieve its potential without functional roads, reliable electricity, access to clean water and basic infrastructure that supports human and economic activities.

Edo North is blessed with hardworking communities and economic potential, but many areas require stronger attention and strategic intervention.

As Senator representing Edo North, I will make infrastructure development one of my major priorities by advocating for projects and policies that improve living conditions across the senatorial district.

My Commitments:

1. Road Development and Rehabilitation

Good roads are essential for:

- Movement of people.
- Transportation of agricultural products.
- Growth of businesses.
- Access to schools and healthcare facilities.

I will work with relevant government agencies to advocate for:

- Rehabilitation of damaged roads.
- Construction of important community roads.
- Improved rural road networks.
- Better connectivity between communities.

My goal is to ensure that communities across Edo North are not isolated from economic opportunities.

2. Electricity and Energy Development

Reliable electricity is necessary for businesses, education and community development.

I will advocate for:

- Improved electricity supply.
- Expansion of electricity access to underserved communities.
- Support for renewable energy solutions.
- Partnerships that promote alternative power sources.

Small businesses cannot grow without dependable energy. Students cannot compete effectively without access to power for learning.

Energy development will remain a key part of my agenda.

3. Water Supply and Environmental Development

Access to clean water is a basic human necessity.

I will support initiatives that encourage:

- Community water projects.
- Improved access to safe drinking water.
- Environmental sanitation programmes.
- Sustainable community development.

PILLAR FIVE

Healthcare Improvement and Community Wellness

The health of our people is the foundation of a productive society.

A community where people cannot access affordable and quality healthcare cannot achieve sustainable development.

My healthcare agenda will focus on improving access, supporting healthcare institutions and promoting preventive healthcare.

My Commitments:

1. Strengthening Community Healthcare

I will advocate for:

- Better equipped primary healthcare centres.
- Support for healthcare interventions in rural communities.
- Improved access to essential medical services.
- Partnerships with health organisations.

Healthcare should not be a privilege only available to those who can afford expensive services.

2. Maternal and Child Healthcare Support

Women and children require special attention.

I will support initiatives focused on:

- Maternal healthcare awareness.
- Child health programmes.
- Support for vulnerable families.
- Improved healthcare education.

3. Health Awareness Campaigns

Prevention remains better than cure.

I will promote awareness programmes around:

- Healthy living.
- Disease prevention.
- Nutrition.
- Community health education.

PILLAR SIX

Women Empowerment and Gender Inclusion

Women are critical contributors to the economic and social development of Edo North.

Across our communities, women are entrepreneurs, farmers, traders, professionals, caregivers and community builders.

Their contributions must be matched with opportunities and support.

My women empowerment agenda will focus on creating more opportunities for women to become economically independent.

My Commitments:

1. Support for Women Entrepreneurs

I will promote initiatives that support women-owned businesses through:

- Entrepreneurship training.
- Business development programmes.
- Access to opportunities.
- Financial empowerment initiatives.

2. Skills Development for Women

I will support programmes that provide women with skills in areas such as:

- Digital entrepreneurship.
- Fashion and creative industries.
- Agriculture.
- Food processing.
- Small business management.

3. Supporting Vulnerable Women

I will advocate for programmes that support:

- Widows.
- Single mothers.
- Women facing economic difficulties.
- Vulnerable members of our communities.

A society progresses when women are empowered.

PILLAR SEVEN

Small Business Growth and Economic Empowerment

Small businesses are the engine of local economies.

From traders in our markets to entrepreneurs operating small enterprises, these individuals create jobs, support families and contribute to community development.

However, many businesses face challenges that limit their growth.

My economic empowerment agenda will focus on creating a better environment for businesses to succeed.

My Commitments:

1. Entrepreneurship Support

I will promote programmes that provide:

- Business training.
- Financial literacy.
- Entrepreneurship mentorship.
- Access to economic opportunities.

2. Supporting Local Enterprises

I will advocate for:

- Better recognition of small businesses.
- Support programmes for entrepreneurs.
- Opportunities for local businesses to participate in economic activities.

3. Youth and Business Innovation

The next generation of businesses will be driven by innovation.

I will encourage:

- Technology-driven businesses.
- Digital entrepreneurship.
- Creative industries.

- Innovation hubs.

Edo North must become a place where ideas can become successful enterprises.

PILLAR EIGHT

Security, Peace and Community Protection

Development cannot happen without security.

Citizens must feel safe to live, work, farm and invest in their communities.

Security is not only the responsibility of government agencies; it requires cooperation between communities, leaders and security institutions.

My Commitments:

I will support:

- Community security initiatives.
- Better collaboration between communities and security agencies.
- Policies that improve safety.
- Youth empowerment programmes that reduce crime.

An empowered young person is less likely to become vulnerable to criminal activities.

PILLAR NINE

Good Governance, Accountability and People-Centred Representation

The relationship between elected representatives and citizens should not end after elections.

True representation requires continuous communication and accountability.

My representation will be built on accessibility and trust.

My Commitments:

1. Regular Community Engagement

I will establish platforms for:

- Town hall meetings.
- Stakeholder discussions.
- Community consultations.
- Citizens' feedback.

2. Transparent Representation

The people deserve to know what their representative is doing.

I will provide updates on:

- Legislative activities.
- Development advocacy.
- Community interventions.
- Achievements and challenges.

3. Open Communication

I will maintain accessible communication channels that allow citizens to share concerns, ideas and recommendations.

My office will belong to the people.

PILLAR TEN

Investment Promotion, Industrial Growth and Economic Expansion

Edo North has enormous economic potential. Our people are hardworking, resourceful and entrepreneurial. However, economic growth requires deliberate strategies that attract investment, support businesses and create opportunities.

A senator must not only make laws; a senator must also become a bridge between the people and opportunities.

My vision is to position Edo North as a district where businesses can grow, investors can find opportunities and young people can build sustainable careers.

My Commitments:

1. Promoting Investment Opportunities in Edo North

I will advocate for initiatives that encourage:

- Private sector investment.
- Public-private partnerships.
- Local enterprise development.
- Industrial expansion.
- Business collaborations.

Edo North must become a destination where investors see opportunity and confidence.

2. Supporting Local Industries

Many communities have talents, resources and traditional skills that can become economic opportunities.

I will support programmes that promote:

- Local production.
- Small-scale industries.
- Manufacturing opportunities.
- Agricultural processing.
- Creative enterprises.

Our people should not only consume; they should also produce and create wealth.

3. Encouraging Digital Economy Growth

The future economy is increasingly digital.

I will advocate for:

- Digital entrepreneurship programmes.
- Technology innovation initiatives.
- Internet access expansion.
- Support for technology-driven businesses.

Edo North youths must be prepared for opportunities beyond geographical boundaries.

PILLAR ELEVEN

Tourism, Culture and Heritage Development

Edo North is blessed with rich cultural heritage, historical sites and traditions that can contribute to economic growth.

Culture is not only about preserving history; it is also an economic opportunity.

My administration will support efforts that promote:

- Cultural preservation.
- Tourism development.
- Community-based tourism.
- Cultural festivals.
- Creative industries.

By promoting our heritage, we can create jobs, attract visitors and strengthen our identity.

PILLAR TWELVE

Legislative Excellence and Effective Advocacy at the Senate

The primary responsibility of a senator is lawmaking, representation and oversight.

My representation at the Senate will focus on ensuring that Edo North benefits from effective legislative participation.

My Legislative Priorities:

1. People-Oriented Laws

I will support legislation that improves:

- Economic opportunities.
- Education.
- Healthcare.
- Security.
- Business development.
- Social welfare.

Every law should answer one important question:

How does this improve the lives of ordinary Nigerians?

2. Advocacy for Edo North Interests

I will consistently bring the concerns of Edo North before relevant government institutions.

Issues affecting our communities will receive serious attention through:

- Motions.
- Bills.
- Committee engagements.
- Government advocacy.

3. Effective Oversight

A senator must ensure that government programmes and projects serve the people.

I will support responsible oversight that promotes:

- Transparency.
- Efficiency.
- Accountability.
- Better public service delivery.

PILLAR THIRTEEN

Youth Leadership and Political Inclusion

Young people are not only leaders of tomorrow; they are partners in leadership today.

Edo North requires a new generation of citizens who are informed, skilled and actively involved in shaping society.

My youth agenda will focus on:

1. Leadership Development

I will support programmes that teach:

- Leadership skills.
- Civic responsibility.
- Entrepreneurship.
- Professional development.

2. Youth Participation

Young people should have opportunities to contribute ideas and participate in development conversations.

I will create platforms where young people can engage with leadership and share solutions.

3. Supporting Young Professionals

Many young professionals possess valuable skills but lack opportunities.

I will promote connections between:

- Young professionals.
- Businesses.
- Institutions.
- Development organisations.

PILLAR FOURTEEN

Community Development and Grassroots Engagement

Leadership must be felt at the grassroots.

Communities are the foundation of society, and their voices must guide development decisions.

My approach will be based on continuous engagement.

My Commitments:

1. Community Listening Sessions

I will regularly engage:

- Traditional rulers.
- Community leaders.
- Youth groups.
- Women associations.
- Professional bodies.
- Religious organisations.

2. Grassroots Development Support

I will advocate for initiatives that respond directly to community needs.

Development must not only happen in major towns; it must reach villages and underserved areas.

3. Partnership With Local Stakeholders

Government alone cannot solve every problem.

I will encourage collaboration between:

- Communities.
- Private organisations.
- Civil society groups.
- Development partners.

PILLAR FIFTEEN

Environmental Sustainability and Future Generations

Development must consider the future.

We must protect our environment while creating economic opportunities.

My environmental agenda will promote:

- Environmental awareness.
- Community sanitation.
- Sustainable development practices.
- Responsible use of natural resources.

Future generations deserve an Edo North that is prosperous and environmentally healthy.

ACCOUNTABILITY FRAMEWORK

How I Will Remain Connected to the People

Leadership without accountability creates distance between representatives and citizens.

My representation will be guided by a clear accountability framework.

1. Regular People's Report

I will provide updates on:

- Legislative activities.
- Development interventions.
- Community engagements.
- Advocacy efforts.

The people deserve to know what their representative is doing.

2. Open Door Representation

My office will remain accessible.

Citizens should be able to:

- Share concerns.
- Provide suggestions.
- Request assistance.
- Participate in development conversations.

3. Community Feedback Mechanism

Leadership improves when leaders listen.

I will establish channels for citizens to provide feedback and communicate their priorities.

MY PERSONAL COMMITMENT TO EDO NORTH

I understand the responsibility that comes with representing the people.

I do not see public office as a reward. I see it as a call to service.

My commitment is to serve with:

Integrity

I will remain honest and transparent in my responsibilities.

Dedication

I will work consistently to advance the interests of Edo North.

Humility

I will remain connected to the people and remember that leadership belongs to the people.

Courage

I will speak for Edo North and defend the interests of our citizens.

A NEW CHAPTER FOR EDO NORTH

The journey ahead requires unity, vision and collective commitment.

Edo North deserves representation that listens.

Edo North deserves representation that works.

Edo North deserves representation that delivers.

Together, we can build a district where opportunities expand, communities prosper and future generations have greater possibilities.

This is not just a campaign promise.

It is a commitment.

It is a vision.

It is **The People First Agenda**.

COMRADE ARUNA ABUBAKARI

ADC SENATORIAL CANDIDATE

EDO NORTH SENATORIAL DISTRICT

Service. Integrity. Development. Representation.